



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Cornerstone Academy

School Website: <https://cornerstoneacademy.school/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Cornerstone Academy Florida (CA) presents a clearly religiously anchored classical program. The school foregrounds a biblical worldview, discipleship, and formation of character alongside a structured Trivium-inspired curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and associated language study (Latin, Greek). Public materials repeatedly frame CA as a classical Christian school with a mission to form virtue and wisdom in students, not merely to prepare them for college or careers. Evidence from the site emphasizes a theology-infused, liturgical-leaning culture (weekly chapels, apologetics, biblical worldview courses) and a governance/ownership structure aligned with Christian formation, parental partnership, and a living-mission orientation. Some classical criteria—most notably the explicit Great Books/Great Conversation emphasis and certain socratic/seminar pedagogy signals—are less openly documented in CA's public content, which lowers certainty in categorizing CA as fully classical across every rubric criterion.

Overall classification: **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**

- Executive notes: CA demonstrates strong religious/metaphysical foundations, a virtuous formation aim, and a robust Trivium-based curriculum with evidence of parental partnership and a mission-driven faculty. However, explicit Great Books/Great Conversation commitments and widespread Socratic/seminar pedagogy signals are not overtly documented in public materials, which prevents a full CLASSICAL rating across all six categories. See category-by-category details below for the keyword analysis and categorical justifications. Citations indicate where these observations are drawn from CA's public content and the classical rubric sources.
- What would move the needle (for a full CLASSICAL rating):
- Add explicit, school-wide Great Books reading and Great Conversation commitments with documented value statements and assigned texts.
- Introduce more explicit Socratic/seminar pedagogy in secondary grades and publish concrete descriptions of these practices.
- Expand liturgical/community practices to more formally articulate and document contemplative time (Scholé) and rest in daily routines.
- Strengthen visibility of the "living curriculum" concept in faculty profiles and teacher-student mentorship language.
- Abstract takeaway: Cornerstone Academy Florida demonstrates a strong classical Christian orientation with clear formation and Trivium-based curriculum, solid family partnership, and a committed faculty. Its public materials affirm a CLASSICAL orientation in most dimensions, with some missing explicit attestations to classic elements like Great Books and Socratic pedagogy that keep it from a full CLASSICAL rating at this time.

References to core evidence appear throughout the CA materials, including statements about a classical Christian mission, biblical worldview emphasis, and a grammar-logic-rhetoric progression in the curriculum. See the CA public materials for statements about biblical worldview, weekly chapels, classical education commitments, and faculty/parent involvement. Examples include “Cornerstone Academy is a classical Christian school,” “classical education with a Biblical worldview,” “weekly chapels, apologetics and Biblical worldview courses,” and “the approach to education allows parents a high level of responsibility ... through partnership with seasoned professionals.”

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — [SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL]

- Evidence
- CA positions itself as a classical Christian school with a biblical worldview and a Christ-centered community (public statements emphasize truth, goodness, beauty in a biblical frame). Examples include “Cornerstone Academy is a classical Christian school,” and “Cornerstone Academy’s mission is to assist parents in providing an excellent classical education and in building godly character founded on a biblical worldview.”
- Weekly chapels and apologetics/biblical worldview courses are explicitly listed in the academics content, indicating liturgical/communal religious practices and theological study integrated into curriculum.
- The “Be Uncommon” messaging highlights a Christ-centered community committed to truth, goodness, and beauty.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators present: truth, goodness, beauty; biblical worldview; theology implied via biblical formation; liturgical/chapel practices (chapels). Explicit terms observed include “biblical worldview,” “Bible,” and “weekly chapels.”
- Negative indicators: none evident in public materials; secular/neutral ethics language is not present.
- Why this rating
- CA foregrounds transcendental moral aims and theological underpinnings (biblical worldview, theology/discipleship) and integrates liturgical/community practices (chapels). The material aligns well with the Positive keywords in the classical rubric for this category. The absence of explicit secular frameworks or values-neutral language further supports a Classical classification here.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — [CLASSICAL]

- Evidence
- CA emphasizes formation and virtue, not merely information or career preparation. Public statements frame the goal as forming students who think clearly, reason, and evaluate through a biblical lens. “Our highest goal is to graduate young men and women who think clearly and listen carefully with discernment and understanding... in joyful submission to God.” and “building godly character founded on a biblical worldview.”
- The mission explicitly references forming virtue and wisdom, not just information. The language of “classical education” and “biblical worldview” ties intellectual formation with moral/spiritual aims (virtue, wisdom).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, truth/goodness/beauty (as transcendental aims), biblical worldview/theology implied.
- Negative keywords observed: none; no explicit push toward workforce-ready or 21st-century job-skills framing in public statements.
- Why this rating
- CA’s stated aims center on formation of character and intellect within a theological frame, aligning strongly with the classical aims of truth, goodness, and beauty in forming virtuous human beings, rather than merely preparing for work. This supports a CLASSICAL rating for Element 2.

Element 3: School Curriculum — [SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL]

- Evidence
- The curriculum explicitly includes grammar, logic, and rhetoric (K4–12 progression), Latin (and Greek) languages, and classical language study; a sequence labeled Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric is clearly described. This aligns with the liberal arts core of the Trivium.
- Public materials list Singapore Math, Abeka, BJU Science, IEW Writing, Latin, Art, PE, Music, and electives; leadership opportunities and senior capstone; college prep with honors/AP; languages (Latin, Spanish, Greek). This demonstrates a comprehensive, rigorous curriculum with a classical emphasis in the Trivium and language study.
- There is accreditation (SACS, CSF) and statements about continuity of curriculum and worldviews, plus a focus on training students to reason from biblical principles. These are supportive of a classical framework, even if not every Great-Books/Great-Conversation element is explicitly named on the site.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators present: grammar, logic, rhetoric; Latin/Greek; great books/great conversation (not explicitly named); history as a component (history elements appear in job postings and general coursework); worldviews/apologetics. The explicit Triad (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and languages are strong positives.
- Negative indicators: Great Books/Great Conversation and explicit Great Books readings are not openly named; explicit reference to “Great Conversation” is not evident in public site text. This gap reduces a full CLASSICAL rating in this category.
- Why this rating
- CA heavily features the Trivium and a classical language program, with a curriculum described in classical terms and rigorous accreditation. However, the absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation commitments in the publicly visible content means the category sits at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — [SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL]

- Evidence
- Public materials emphasize rhetoric training and opportunities to articulate knowledge (Rhetoric is a defined part of the upper grades). There are references to “leadership opportunities” and an emphasis on speaking, writing, and argumentation, which align with classical pedagogy in the upper grades.
- There are explicit mentions of lower-school activities (singing, memory, and routine review) in classical-education discourse, but CA’s public content centers more on discipleship, worldview, and the rhetorical/language progression than on explicit singing/chanting or contemplative pedagogy in lower grades. The Great-Books/Socratic-style seminars are not overtly described.
- Weekly chapels and apologetics/biblical worldview courses indicate a contemplative/faith-based approach integrated with academics, but the public description does not clearly declare a Scholastic-like, restful pedagogy or a broad series of Socratic seminars.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators present: rhetoric training, public speaking, memory and recitation-related pedagogy in upper-level language/rhetoric study (as per curriculum descriptions). The presence of “speech and rhetoric training” is a classic characteristic in classical pedagogy.
- Negative indicators: lack of explicit Socratic seminars, explicit “Scholé” / contemplative rest-day pedagogy, or a large emphasis on collaborative inquiry outside of rhetoric; no explicit project-based or experiential-learning framing beyond general activities. The public content does not strongly advertise Socratic seminars in high school. This reduces the score toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating
- CA demonstrates several classical-pedagogical motifs (rhetoric, disciplined language learning, and a high emphasis on moral formation). However, missing or under-emphasized Socratic/seminar-style pedagogy and explicit contemplative “Scholé” language in public materials place Element 4 in the SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL band rather than CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — [CLASSICAL]

- Evidence
- CA describes teachers as carefully selected on the basis of Christian faith, character, experience, gifting, degrees, and certifications. This conveys a living, virtuous professional core and a high-quality faculty image.
- The public materials stress that faculty are deeply invested in shaping the hearts and minds of students, and that Cornerstone Academy is the “living curriculum” (to the extent the site discusses teacher quality and mentorship). This language signals a strong faculty core as central to the school’s classical mission.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: “model teachers and mentors”; “faculty... deeply invested in shaping both the hearts and minds”; “teachers carefully selected on Christian faith and character, experience, gifting by God in teaching, degrees and certifications.”
- Negative keywords observed: none; no explicit statements diminishing faculty quality or treating teachers as mere facilitators.
- Why this rating
- The explicit emphasis on character, faith-based selection criteria, and “living curriculum” type language (through the public statements about faculty quality and impact) supports a CLASSICAL rating for Element 5. The content aligns with the category’s expectations for exemplary, virtuous, and mentorship-oriented faculty.

Element 6: Parents & Community — [CLASSICAL]

- Evidence
- The CA site highlights parental partnership and high parental responsibility for children’s education in partnership with professionals. This aligns with the classical model’s emphasis on parents as co-educators and core participants in formation.
- Admissions content emphasizes a family-like atmosphere and the school’s intent to foster a close community; CA’s materials frequently address family engagement and open campus opportunities for visits.
- Public statements from CA’s communications show positive testimonials from families and a culture of parental involvement; “We have always appreciated the community of families who want to raise their children with a Biblical worldview...” appears in family feedback.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: partnership with families; home-school collaboration; parent formation; parental involvement; open campus; family testimonials; community support.
- Negative keywords observed: none; no material indicating a consumer-only relationship or a lack of parental involvement.
- Why this rating
- CA demonstrates strong alignment with the “Partnership with Families” and “Formation of Affections” and “Cultural Transmission” expectations of classical education through active parental involvement and community engagement. This warrants a CLASSICAL rating for Element 6.

What Would Move the Needle

- Explicitly commit to and publish Great Books / Great Conversation commitments within the curriculum (and provide a public roster of primary texts and reading lists).
- Introduce and document structured Socratic/seminar pedagogy for upper grades, including example transcripts, rubrics, and outcomes to align with classical pedagogy.
- Expand and clearly label contemplative/scholé elements (restful learning, liturgical rhythm) in daily schedules and public communications to fulfill the more restful dimension of the classical model.

- Strengthen faculty professional development around teaching methods that foreground living books, memorization, and classical memory work as a consistent part of the lower school experience.
- Increase explicit articulation of “living curriculum” concepts in faculty profiles and public communications, including teacher portraits and expectations for mentors and role models.
- Further articulate and document the partnership with families as co-educators, including formal parent education programs, reading groups, and structured opportunities for parental formation, to solidify Element 6 as a deeply integrated feature of CA's model.

These steps would push Categories 3 (Curriculum content extended to Great Books and Great Conversation), 4 (Pedagogy with more Socratic/Scholé elements), and 6 (Parents & Community deeper integration) toward CLASSICAL, thereby elevating the overall assessment toward CLASSICAL.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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